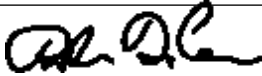


Guideline Title: Eye Injuries

Guideline Number: GUID-3203-T006

Issue date: 09/09/2014	Replaces Dept. Policy:
Revision dates: 07/01/2026	Developed by: Air Care Team
Approved by: Dr. Danielle DiCesare, MD Air Care Team Medical Director	Approved by:
Signature: 	Signature:
Department Numbers: 3203	

- I. **PURPOSE:** To recognize eye injury or potential for eye injury and provide rapid transport to the nearest appropriate facility while preventing any further damage from occurring.
- II. **PATHOPHYSIOLOGY:** Eye injuries can involve any portion of the eye or its surrounding structures. The pupils may become irregularly shaped because of a ruptured globe or prolapse of the iris. It is important to assess for traumatic hyphema or asymmetric proptosis (bulging of the globe).
- III. **DEFINITIONS:**
- IV. **DEPARTMENT GUIDELINE:**
 - a. If shield is already in place, make sure no pressure is being applied to globe itself.
 - b. If available, apply appropriate rigid shield over affected eye. Consider patching or shielding unaffected eye for comfort and to minimize movement.
 - c. If chemical injury exists, irrigate eye for 15-30 minutes with normal saline.
 - d. Remove superficial, non-impacted foreign bodies from the eyelids. Do not attempt to remove any intraocular foreign bodies.
 - e. Stabilize any impaled object with gauze and cling to prevent movement. Do not remove any impaled object. Consider covering the unaffected eye to minimize movement.
 - f. Avoid eye manipulation as much as possible
 - g. An open globe injury is a relative contraindication for use of succinylcholine, if patient requires rapid sequence intubation rocuronium is recommended for paralysis
 - h. Utilize antiemetics to avoid increased intraocular pressure caused by vomiting.
 - i. If hyphema exists and there are no contraindications, transport with head of bed elevated to at least 45 degrees
 - j. During flight, maintain as low an altitude as is safely possible
- V. **DOCUMENTATION:** EMS Charts
- VI. **REFERENCES:**